Clark Peng

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles — Los Angeles, CA
B.S. in Computer Science (GPA: 4.0) — *Expected June 2028*

Distinctions

ICPC SoCal Regional Top 10 | USACO Platinum | Codeforces Expert | USAPhO Silver | Kaggle Top 1%

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C++17/20, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, Bash
Web and Cloud: Node.js, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, WebSockets, React, Cloudflare Workers, AWS (EC2, S3)
Systems: Linux, GDB, CMake, CUDA, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions
Machine Learning: PyTorch, FSDP, distributed training, LLM evaluation

Experience

Catapult (YC S26) — San Francisco, CA
Co-founder and CTO — *Jun 2026 – Present*

- Built a real-time platform for 30 games (rooms, friends, ratings, replays) on TypeScript, PostgreSQL, and Cloudflare.
- Designed reconnect-safe game rooms with idempotent moves, so a retried move is never applied twice.
- Built a game API that ran 19 frontier LLMs through 1K games, producing 257M tokens of gameplay data.
- Built Music Arena's first version, where people vote on AI music, and its C++ plugin for composing in FL Studio.

Camfer (YC S24) — San Francisco, CA
Software Engineering Intern — *Aug 2025 – Dec 2025*

- Improved vision-language model training throughput 10x through sequence packing and data preparation.
- Built a sharded pipeline turning 800K CAD parts into 600M+ training tokens; adding Onshape doubled reachable users.
- Built async EC2 rollouts for model error correction and a CAD replay tool that caught errors integration tests missed.

UCLA NLP Group — Los Angeles, CA
Student Researcher — *Oct 2024 – Present*

- Co-authored **VideoPhy-2** (ICLR 2026, ICML workshop Best Paper); built the pipeline that grew its dataset 6x.
- Made multilingual mixture-of-experts training 2.1x faster on the same GPU; the team adopted it as the default.

Scale AI — Los Angeles, CA
Technical Intern — *Nov 2024 – Aug 2025*

- Wrote 100+ expert competitive-programming solutions used as training data for LLMs at frontier labs.
- Designed judges and rubrics for reinforcement learning on coding agents in deterministic Docker environments.

HMC Music Retrieval Lab — Claremont, CA
Research Intern — *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*

- Developed new methods for steering what MusicGen generates, tested across 1M+ audio clips.

Projects

Kaggle | *Silver Medal, First-Author Paper, 5+ Gold Notebooks (20k+ Forks)* — 2023 – 2025

- Developed a probability-density regression method for event detection, adopted by nearly all top teams of 1,877.

Graphics | *C++, OpenGL, Unity* — 2022 – Present

- Built a C++/OpenGL 4D game engine, a Unity GPU slime simulation (1M agents, 120 FPS), and C++ raytracers.

Leadership

UCLA ACM AI | *Co-President* — Nov 2025 – Present

- Run ACM AI's 800-member community and 40-officer team across research tracks, ML hackathons, and events drawing thousands of participants; secured club sponsors.